

Logos 聚会

2026-06-27

使徒行传 6:1- 60

关键点

本次查经聚会围绕使徒行传第七章展开，完整学习了斯提反在公会前的讲道及其殉道经过。斯提反以以色列历史为脉络，通过亚伯拉罕、约瑟、摩西三位人物，系统论证神无处不在、不受圣殿局限，并直接指控宗教领袖拒绝神所差派之人的罪行。讲道以斯提反被石头打死、扫罗（保罗）首次出现作结，标志着福音向普世传播的历史转折点。下周将继续学习第八章。

背景：斯提反被捕与受审

- **身份**：斯提反是七位执事之一，被圣灵充满、大有智慧，属平信徒领袖而非使徒。
- **被捕原因**：他在会堂中大胆传讲耶稣基督，与宗教领袖辩论屡胜，对方嫉妒恼怒，遂捏造罪名——指控他**反对摩西律法、反对圣殿、反对上帝**。
- **同样的控告**：耶稣被钉十字架前所受的指控与此完全相同，这是宗教当权者惯用的打压手段。
- **应对方式对比**：
 - 耶稣面对指控选择**沉默**，不为自己辩护。
 - 斯提反同样不为己辩，而是**借机传讲福音**，以历史为证据展开最长的一篇讲道（贯穿整个第七章）。

讲道结构：七段历史叙述

斯提反的讲道分七个小节，核心主题贯穿始终：**神不受地域或圣殿限制，以色列人却有悖逆、拒绝神所差派之人的历史传统**。

第一节：亚伯拉罕的蒙召（第 2-8 节）

- 神呼召亚伯拉罕时，他身处**美索不达米亚平原**，尚未进入迦南地，更无圣殿。
- **核心论点**：以色列人误以为神只居住在圣殿中，圣殿已成为他们的偶像；但神早在圣殿存在之前便已向外邦地的亚伯拉罕显现。
- 亚伯拉罕本是外邦人出身，神却拣选并与他立约，证明神是**全世界的神**，而非仅属以色列。

第二节：约瑟被卖与蒙福（第 9-16 节）

- 约瑟被兄弟们嫉妒卖往**埃及**，神却在埃及与他同在，赐他恩典与智慧，使他成为法老之下的宰相，拯救了以色列全家及周边民族度过饥荒。
- **拒绝的主题**：约瑟被自己的兄弟（以色列十二支派的先祖）拒绝，这是以色列人拒绝神所差派之人的历史起点。

- **预表关系：**

- 约瑟预表耶稣——
同被本族人拒绝，却成为拯救者；神不仅与被拒绝者同在，更高举他们。
- 约瑟拯救了兄弟与全族，耶稣则拯救全人类；两者都是救主的形象。

第三节：摩西的故事（第 17-43 节）

此段篇幅最长，分两部分讨论：

摩西的蒙召与被拒（第 17-29 节）

- 摩西生于被压迫的环境，被法老女儿收养，习得埃及一切学问；40 岁时主动为以色列人伸张正义，却被同胞拒绝，质问："谁立你做我们的首领？"
- 摩西逃往**米甸**（外邦人居住之地），神在那里以火焰向他显现——再次印证神无处不在。
- 摩西同样是**耶稣基督的预表**：神应许"要为你们兴起一位先知像我"，指向弥赛亚耶稣。

以色列人造金牛犊（第 40-43 节）

- 摩西上山领受十诫期间，以色列人造金牛犊拜偶像，彻底拒绝神——这是以色列**悖逆传统**的典型例证。
- 以色列人拜偶像的历史贯穿始终，圣殿本是神赐予他们的礼物，却被他们变成偶像。

第四节：帐幕与圣殿（第 44-50 节）

- 帐幕是神为让以色列人感知他同在而设立的，是圣殿的雏形，目的是**表明神与子民同在**，而非将神局限于某一建筑。
- 第 48 节明言："至高者并不住人手所造的殿"——
天是神的座位，地是他的脚凳，神是创造万有、托住万有的主。
- **宗教化的危险**：以色列人将圣殿变成偶像，将信仰变成无关乎内心的宗教仪式，类似于今天所说的"星期天基督徒"——只有外在形式，内心与神毫无真实关系。

讲道高潮：直接指控（第 51-53 节）

- 斯提反在此发出最严厉的谴责，语气尖锐直接：
 - *****你们这硬着颈项、心与耳未受割礼的人，常时抗拒圣灵*****——
以色列人表面宗教虔诚，实则从未真正顺服神。
 - 你们的祖先逼迫并杀害了预告弥赛亚将来的先知；而你们，**亲手杀害了那位义者——耶稣基督**。
 - 你们领受了天使所传的律法，却**一条也不遵守**。
- **总结性论点**：以色列人的整部历史就是一部**反复拒绝神所差派之人**的历史——
从约瑟到摩西到众先知，直到最终的弥赛亚；斯提反被抓，不过是这一传统的延续。

神学核心：神无处不在

贯穿整篇讲道的神学主轴，由 Guk 多次强调：

- **神不受任何地理位置或建筑物限制——**
可以在家中、在路上、在车里、在中国、在非洲，神无处不在。
- 人类天然倾向于将神具象化、宗教化，制造可见的偶像或仪式体系，但这不过是**没有神的空洞宗教**。
- 神渴望与人建立**真实的爱的关系**，而非仅仅被供奉在宗教制度之中；他是父亲、朋友、救赎者。
- 引用罗马书的教导：神所造的美丽花朵无需人浇灌便能生长，这本身就彰显神的**荣耀与托住万有的能力**。

斯提反的殉道（第 54–60 节）

群众的反应

- 众人听完讲道，**极其恼怒、咬牙切齿——**
因为真理触动了他们的不顺服，却没有带来悔改，反而激起愤怒。
- 他们将斯提反推出城外，用石头打他；做见证的人将衣裳放在**少年人扫罗**脚前。

斯提反的异象与祷告

- 被石头打时，斯提反被圣灵充满，**看见天开了，耶稣站在神的右边**。
- **"站"的特殊意义**：圣经其他处均记载耶稣"坐"在神右边，唯独此处用"站"——
象征耶稣起身**迎接、欢迎第一位殉道者**，是对斯提反忠心的荣耀肯定。
- 断气前的最后祷告：**"求主耶稣接收我的灵魂"**，并跪下呼求："主啊，不要将这罪归于他们。" 30
◦ 此举与耶稣在十字架上的祷告（"父啊，赦免他们"）形成深刻呼应，彰显斯提反真正活出了效法基督的生命。

历史意义：新时代的开始

扫罗（保罗）的首次出现

- 扫罗在场，负有**从更高权柄领命监督执行迫害行动**的职责，是斯提反被打死的见证人。
- 关于"做见证的人把衣裳放在扫罗脚前"：
 - Guk 认为原因不完全确定，可能是当时的仪式惯例，或为方便行动而脱去外衣。
 - Jane 英子补充：扫罗当时并未亲自参与投石，而是作为监督者在场见证；保罗后来在自己的见证中也提及此事。
- 扫罗后来改名**保罗**，成为神拣选向外邦人传福音的使徒——
十二使徒多在犹太人工作中，保罗则是**真正被差往外邦世界的人**。

福音普世传播的转折点

- 斯提反的死触发了对教会**的大逼迫**，使徒们被迫离开耶路撒冷，福音由此开始向撒玛利亚和地极扩散——正应验使徒行传 1:8 的预言。

- 斯提反虽只是执事（平信徒领袖），其殉道却成为**教会历史上第一次殉道**，开启了使徒行传新的历史篇章。

Logos Meeting

Acts 6:1 - 60, 2026-06-27

Key Outcomes

This Bible study focused on Acts Chapter 7, examining Stephen's historic speech before the Sanhedrin and his martyrdom. Stephen used three figures—Abraham, Joseph, and Moses—as a framework to systematically demonstrate that God is omnipresent and not confined to the temple, while revealing Israel's historical pattern of rebelling against God and rejecting those He sent, directly connecting this to the rejection of Jesus Christ. The speech concluded with Stephen being stoned to death, but his death became a historical turning point for the spread of the gospel to the entire world.

Background: Stephen's Arrest and Trial

His Identity

Stephen was one of the seven deacons, full of the Holy Spirit and wisdom. He was a lay leader rather than one of the apostles.

Why Was He Arrested?

Stephen boldly proclaimed Jesus Christ in the synagogues and repeatedly prevailed in debates with the religious leaders. Filled with jealousy and anger, they fabricated charges against him, accusing him of opposing Moses, the Law, and God.

The Same Accusations Against Jesus

These accusations were identical to those made against Jesus before His crucifixion. This was a common tactic used by the religious authorities to suppress those who threatened their power.

Different Responses

- Jesus chose to remain silent and did not defend Himself.
- Likewise, Stephen did not defend himself. Instead, he used the opportunity to preach the gospel, delivering the longest speech recorded in Acts.

Structure of Stephen's Speech: Seven Historical Sections

The central theme throughout Stephen's speech is that God is not limited by geography or the temple, while Israel has a long history of rebelling against and rejecting those whom God sent.

1. The Calling of Abraham (Acts 7:2–8)

God called Abraham while he was still in Mesopotamia, before he entered Canaan and long before the temple existed.

Main Point: The Israelites mistakenly believed that God dwelt only in the temple, turning the temple into an idol. Yet God revealed Himself to Abraham outside the Promised Land and before any temple existed.

Abraham himself came from a Gentile background, yet God chose him and made a covenant with him, demonstrating that God is the God of the whole world, not merely of Israel.

2. Joseph Rejected but Blessed (Acts 7:9–16)

Joseph was sold into Egypt by his jealous brothers, yet God was with him there, granting him favor and wisdom and raising him up to become Pharaoh's second-in-command. Through Joseph, God saved Israel and many surrounding nations from famine.

The Theme of Rejection

Joseph was rejected by his own brothers, the ancestors of the twelve tribes of Israel. This marks the beginning of Israel's pattern of rejecting those whom God sends.

Typology

Joseph foreshadows Jesus:

- Both were rejected by their own people.
- Both became saviors.
- God was with the rejected and exalted them.

Joseph saved his family and nation; Jesus saves all humanity.

3. The Story of Moses (Acts 7:17–43)

This is the longest section of Stephen's speech.

Moses' Calling and Rejection (Acts 7:17–29)

Moses was born during Israel's oppression and was adopted by Pharaoh's daughter, receiving all the wisdom of Egypt. At age forty, he tried to defend his fellow Israelites, but they rejected him, asking:

"Who made you ruler and judge over us?"

Moses fled to Midian, a Gentile land, where God appeared to him in the burning bush—again demonstrating that God is present everywhere.

Moses also foreshadowed Christ. God promised:

"God will raise up for you a prophet like me."

This pointed forward to the Messiah, Jesus.

The Golden Calf (Acts 7:40–43)

While Moses was receiving the Ten Commandments on Mount Sinai, the Israelites made and worshiped a golden calf, completely rejecting God.

The history of Israel is filled with idolatry. Even the temple, which God gave as a gift, eventually became an idol in their hearts.

4. The Tabernacle and the Temple (Acts 7:44–50)

The tabernacle was established so that Israel could experience God's presence. It was the forerunner of the temple and symbolized God's dwelling among His people, not His confinement to a building.

Verse 48 declares:

"The Most High does not dwell in houses made by human hands."

Heaven is God's throne and the earth His footstool. He is the Creator and Sustainer of all things.

The Danger of Religion Without Relationship

The Israelites turned the temple into an idol and reduced faith to empty religious rituals. This is similar to what we call "Sunday Christians" today—people who possess outward forms of religion but lack a genuine relationship with God.

The Climax of the Speech: A Direct Accusation (Acts 7:51–53)

Stephen delivered one of the strongest rebukes in Scripture:

"You stiff-necked people, uncircumcised in heart and ears, you always resist the Holy Spirit."

Although the Israelites appeared religious outwardly, they had never truly submitted to God.

- Their ancestors persecuted and killed the prophets who foretold the coming of the Messiah.
- They themselves had betrayed and murdered the Righteous One, Jesus Christ.
- They received the Law through angels yet failed to obey it.

Summary

The entire history of Israel is a history of repeatedly rejecting those whom God sent—from Joseph to Moses to the prophets, and ultimately to the Messiah Himself. Stephen's arrest was simply another continuation of this tragic pattern.

Theological Theme: God Is Everywhere

Throughout the entire speech, Guk repeatedly emphasized this truth:

- God is not confined to any geographical location or building.
- He can be with us at home, on the road, in our cars, in China, in Africa—everywhere.

Human beings naturally tend to make God tangible and controllable by creating idols or religious systems. Yet this becomes empty religion without a real relationship with God.

God desires a genuine relationship of love with us. He is our Father, Friend, and Redeemer.

As Romans teaches, the beauty of creation itself reveals God's glory and His sustaining power over all things.

The Martyrdom of Stephen (Acts 7:54–60)

The People's Reaction

When the people heard Stephen's message, they were furious and gnashed their teeth. The truth exposed their disobedience, but instead of repenting, they became enraged.

They dragged Stephen outside the city and stoned him, while the witnesses laid their garments at the feet of a young man named Saul.

Stephen's Vision and Prayer

As he was being stoned, Stephen, filled with the Holy Spirit, saw heaven opened and Jesus standing at the right hand of God.

The Significance of Jesus "Standing"

Elsewhere in Scripture, Jesus is described as sitting at the right hand of God. Here alone He is said to be standing, symbolizing His welcoming and honoring of His first martyr.

Before dying, Stephen prayed:

"Lord Jesus, receive my spirit."

Then he knelt and cried out:

"Lord, do not hold this sin against them."

This closely echoes Jesus' prayer on the cross:

"Father, forgive them."

Stephen truly lived out a Christlike life.

Historical Significance: The Beginning of a New Era

The First Appearance of Saul (Paul)

Saul was present and apparently had authority over the persecution. He witnessed Stephen's execution.

Regarding the statement that the witnesses laid their garments at Saul's feet:

- Guk suggested that the exact reason is uncertain; it may have been a customary practice or simply to free themselves for the execution.
- Jane Yingzi added that Saul did not personally throw stones but supervised the event and later referred to it in his own testimony.

Saul would later become Paul, the apostle chosen by God to bring the gospel to the Gentile world.

A Turning Point in the Spread of the Gospel

Stephen's death triggered a great persecution against the church. Believers were scattered from Jerusalem, and the gospel began to spread to Samaria and to the ends of the earth, fulfilling the prophecy of Acts 1:8.

Though Stephen was only a deacon and lay leader, his martyrdom became the first martyrdom in church history and opened a new chapter in the Book of Acts.